



Welcome to Purpose



An Introduction to God's Purpose for Your Life

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PART ONE



The Question of Purpose



“It is only the maker of a thing that can reveal the purpose for which he made it.”

The Purpose Question

Just like every other human in the world, you are burdened with the question of purpose.

We all want an objectively true and clear answer to the question: *Why are we here?*

If you already believe in the reality of God and the redemption in Christ Jesus, this question can be better framed this way:

Why did God create the world? What is God's purpose? And what is His specific purpose for my life?

(If you are yet to believe, you should get the book [How the Gospel Proves Itself to be the Truth at www.pleros.org](http://www.pleros.org).)

An Illustration on Purpose

Now, to answer this question of purpose, let's examine this illustration:

Imagine you were sent by your Dad to go visit your brother, who has not been reachable for a while. Upon getting to your brother's place, you notice he is doing some woodwork.

Then your Dad calls you to find out what is going on. You respond that he is crafting a product with wood.

Now this is where you need to pay attention.

If your Dad then asks, “What exactly is he making?” you would have to take a closer look at the product and think a bit to figure it out.

Let’s say it dawns on you and you respond, “He is making a wooden table.”

But your Dad, surprised, responds, “Why exactly is he making a table?”

What do you say?

Purpose Requires Revelation

This is precisely the challenge with the question of purpose. You cannot know why your brother is making the table unless he reveals it to you.

You could tell *what* he made by observation and reason. But you can’t tell *why* until he discloses it to you.

It is clear that it’s only the maker of a thing that can reveal the purpose for which he made it.

This is what the purpose question demands — revelation. Not just observation and reason.

We know what God made: the cosmos and humanity. The entire world, and humans in that world.

But why?

THE PURPOSE QUESTION

Why did He make this world? What was the reason on His heart? Why did He make you?

We can only know this if He reveals it to us.

The question now is: how do we find the revelation of His purpose?

Finding God's Revelation



If we accept that there is God as the Creator of the world, and also accept that He accomplished redemption in Christ Jesus, then we are very close to finding the revelation of God.

(If you are yet to accept this, you should get the book [How the Gospel Proves Itself to be the Truth](http://www.pleros.org) at www.pleros.org.)

He has revealed Himself in Christ Jesus, and this is authoritatively proven by His resurrection. The historical reality of the resurrection validates the Lord Jesus as the direct bearer of divine authority who unveils to us the legitimate and authoritative revelation of God ([Luke 10:21-22](#)).

The Lord Jesus endorsed the Old Testament Scriptures as divine revelation, and used them in several instances to establish God's truth ([Luke 24:25-27, 44-46](#); [John 10:35](#); [Matt. 22:29](#)).

He further gives the authority to conclusively present God's truth and revelation to His apostles, whose records make up the New Testament Text of the Bible.

Altogether, we can conclude that God shows us that the Bible — made up of the Old and New Testament Texts — is the document He has divinely orchestrated as the authoritative source of His truth and revelation.

Therefore, if it takes revelation to know God's purpose, and the Bible is the authorised revelation of God, we would have to look within the Bible to find out what God has revealed His purpose to be.

What Exactly is God's Purpose

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The clearest place we find God's purpose revealed in the Bible is in Ephesians 1, where Paul provides a fully developed understanding of this truth.

In Ephesians 1:9, he states that God has made known His will (what He wants), which is based on His good pleasure (what He likes) that He purposed or determined in Himself.

Think about it this way:

Think about your favourite food — you usually don't have a logical reason for preferring that food over all other options. Yet you just do. That's exactly what *good pleasure* implies.

Now imagine you wake up one day with a craving for this food. It means this good pleasure has now become your *will* — something you want in the moment.

You may choose to yield to the craving for your favourite food, or simply resist it.

If you decide to go ahead and get the food, what happened to be your *good pleasure*, that became your *will*, has finally become your purpose — something you're determined to obtain.

This illustrates the point Paul was making in Eph. 1:9: that God has made known His *will*, which was first His *good pleasure*, that He finally determined or purposed to have.

So to know God's purpose, we need to find out His good pleasure and will.

Interestingly, this is answered in the very same chapter.



“Having predestined us to adoption as sons by Jesus Christ to Himself, according to the good pleasure of His will.”

EPHESIANS 1:5

We could read the above text in another way to make it clearer:

According to the good pleasure of His will, He predestined us to adoption of sons by Jesus Christ to Himself.

Sonship as God's Purpose

This implies that God predestined redemption in Christ to bring us to adoption of sons, because it is the good pleasure of His will.

Therefore, “adoption of sons” is the good pleasure of His will.

The phrase “adoption as sons” is just one word in the Greek, *huiiothesia*, which is arguably best translated as “Sonship”. Therefore, the good pleasure of His will is Sonship.

Recall that in Eph. 1:9, Paul says that God purposed the good pleasure of His will in Himself. If the good pleasure of His will is Sonship, then God’s purpose is Sonship.

Beyond a shadow of doubt, in clear and most definite terms, God has revealed His purpose for us to be Sonship.

Let us go on to see what this means.

Explaining God's Purpose



Romans 8:15-17 provides the most comprehensive explanation of Sonship, helping us see why the common term “adoption” can be a misleading way to describe God’s purpose.

This text shows that every believer has received the Spirit of Sonship, which leads us to cry out “Abba, Father” in intimacy. This describes a natural cry expected of a naturally born child at infancy, and not an adopted one.

This text further explains that our human spirit and the Spirit we received from God, having been made one (1 Cor. 6:17), have the same testimony of the realities of Sonship.

These two-fold realities make up Sonship:

1. that we are children of God; and
2. that we are heirs of God, joint-heirs with Christ.

For the first reality of Sonship — that we are children of God — he uses the Greek word *teknon* for “children”, a word that describes those who have been actually reproduced or birthed by another.

This means we are not merely outsiders selected for a family, but actual children who share the Father's very life and nature through a spiritual birth. There are other texts of Scripture that attest to this: 1 Pet. 1:23; James 1:18; 1 John 3:1-2; 1 John 5:4; 2 Pet. 1:4.

The second reality of Sonship is that we are heirs of God. An heir is one who is allotted or assigned what is owned by another. Upon being allotted or assigned what belongs to another, the heir has both ownership and responsibility to manage this allotment.

God, therefore, not only desired that we be His children; He also wants to assign and allot what He owns to us.

This was always God's purpose: to have a family — His very own children, to whom He can allot and assign what He owns as His heirs.

Now, we don't only know that God's eternal purpose is Sonship; we also now know what it means.

We were made, and we exist, to be children of God and heirs of God. It defines our identity and our pursuits — who we are and what we are called to do.

But then, what does this mean practically for our lives? What exactly are we to do as children of God? What has been assigned and allotted to us to own and manage as heirs of God?

As we continue our study, answering these questions will make clear what we were created to pursue, fulfill and accomplish in our lifetime in this age.

PART TWO



The Realities of Sonship



*“And if children, then heirs — heirs of God and joint
heirs with Christ.”*

ROMANS 8:17

The First Reality of God's Purpose

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The first reality of God's purpose, testified of by our spirit and God's Spirit, is that we are children of God. But what exactly are we called to as children?

Naturally, when a child is born, the child has zero sense of responsibility until they reach a certain age.

All they know to do is enjoy fellowship and communion with their parents.

This is similarly true of our relationship with God. God always wanted to be our Father. Upon faith in Christ, we are His children. And the initial expression we are told that follows this new birth is that we cry "Abba, Father" ([Romans 8:15](#); [Galatians 4:6](#)).

This means fellowship and communion with God is what we're primarily called to as His children. Before we ever think of what to do, what to pursue and fulfill, our primary concern should be the relationship we have with our Father and the fellowship it calls for.

Now, this fellowship with God as Father happens in the place of prayer and worship. We should not view prayer primarily through the lens of making demands, requests or supplication. It is first and foremost about fellowship with the Father.

Remember that at birth, all a child gets to do is fellowship with their parents. However, the joys of this fellowship are also accompanied by the burden for the child to grow.

This reveals to us the second expression of being children of God. We are not only called to fellowship; we are also called to grow and walk in the new life, nature and character we have received in Christ.

Since we are not children of God by adoption but by birth, we have His life, nature and Spirit in us. We are partakers of the divine nature.

God's nature is not in us for us to merely be aware of it. It is rather in us with the specific intention that we walk in it as we grow — that we walk in the character of the Spirit, in righteousness and love.

Just like our fellowship with God, our growth in our new nature in Christ, which leads to our walk, happens in the place of prayer.

We can conclude that, as children of God, we are called to a life of fellowship with God, as well as to grow and walk in our divine nature in Christ. And both of these things call us to a daily, committed and consistent life of prayer.

The Second Reality of God's Purpose

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You already know that God's purpose is Sonship, and have examined the first reality of Sonship, which is to be His child. But God's desire is not just to have us as children, but also as His heirs.

We'll go on now to explain what it means to be an heir of God.

The word heir — *kleronomos* in the Greek — refers to someone who has a portion, lot or asset assigned or allotted to him. The assigned portion or lot is called their inheritance (*kleronomia*).

Therefore, if we are heirs of God, it means He has assigned to us a certain portion or allotment. And this inheritance isn't allotted to us just to own, but to manage and be responsible for as well.

The question we need to answer now is: what are the things God has assigned to us to own and manage?

When we run through the Scriptures, we can see three classes of inheritance that we have received:

1. First, we have God's Spirit as an inheritance given to us. By giving us His Spirit, He has given us of Himself, His life and nature as our inheritance (Gal. 3:14).

This understanding of inheritance simply reaffirms the first reality of Sonship: that we are children of God, who have His life and Spirit.

2. Second, the entire cosmos — the whole world, or the Earth — is described as our joint inheritance. Since God is the creator of the cosmos, He has ownership right over it, and gives it to His children as an inheritance (Rom. 8:17-21; Matt. 5:5).

It is on account of our position as joint heirs of the cosmos that the cosmos will be delivered from its present state of corruption into the desired state of life and incorruption.

But in this present age, this truth of being joint heirs is meant to be exercised by faithfulness to our civic responsibility — where we play our part as global and local citizens to order our world after righteousness as much as possible.

Civic responsibility is an important part of God's purpose for our life, as joint heirs of the cosmos.

3. The most important understanding of our place as heirs of God is the personal and individual assignment that God gives to us.

Beyond giving us His Spirit and making us joint heirs of the world, He gives each of us individual assignments to pursue and fulfill in His purpose.

God's Word reveals that there are two individual assignments He allots us: a natural assignment and a spiritual assignment.

We would see the word “inheritance” used for both the natural assignment and the spiritual assignment God gives to us. Let’s examine them one after the other, starting with our natural assignment.

Our Assignment as Heirs I



We see a direct use of the word “inheritance” to describe our natural pursuits in Colossians 3:24.

In addressing those we would regard today as employees, Paul describes their work as an inheritance allotted to them by God, for which they will give account before Him at the end.

In Colossians 4:1, Paul makes a similar appeal to masters — or, in our context, employers and bosses. This shows that what we do in the natural, whether in career, academics, business or social causes, is an integral part of God’s purpose for our lives.

Our natural pursuits should not be regarded as activities done merely for survival or personal ambition. They are to be rightly judged as an assignment given to us by God in His purpose for our lives.

At this juncture, we may want to ask: how do I know the exact natural assignment God gives me to pursue? Does He directly dictate it to me?

The answer we find in God’s Word unfolds in phases.

First, we learn that God allots to each person the very starting conditions in which they are found at the point of salvation. In other words, when you enter into God's purpose through salvation, the work and conditions in which you already find yourself become the initial phase of the natural assignment the Lord gives you to steward, as we see in 1 Corinthians 7:17, 20-21.

The only exception is where the work you were doing is unrighteous, which you should simply repent from, as stated in Ephesians 4:28.

Subsequently, we are taught that beyond the starting conditions of our life, we should go further to take advantage of opportunities that offer us better conditions and outcomes.

Notice in 1 Corinthians 7:20-21 that Paul teaches that while the condition of being a slave may have been a person's initial allotment by God, freedom should be embraced if the opportunity becomes available.

This means we have the liberty and encouragement to find and harness opportunities that are available, or that come to us, to be better.

The final phase of our natural assignment is the right to pursue righteous desires and ambitions we personally have under God.

In 1 Corinthians 7:31, Paul teaches that we may use and harness the world, provided we do not misuse it or become overwhelmed by it. Ephesians 4:28 also instructs us to work with our hands whatever we want, as long as it is good, and especially with the intention to meet our needs and those of others.

One thing is clear: God gives us the liberty of our will when it comes to our natural assignments — to navigate the journey from our starting conditions, into taking advantage of opportunities, and finally pursuing what we personally desire.

This is unlike spiritual assignment, where we are chosen and elected into specific roles.

We should, however, not ignore the role of the leading of the Spirit to confirm major decisions as we pursue our natural assignment.

The primary role of the leading of the Spirit is not to decide for us, since God already gave us the liberty to choose when it comes to our natural assignment. Instead, the leading of the Spirit would primarily serve to approve or disapprove major decisions that we intend to make.

Let us conclude with the most emphatic instruction given relative to our natural assignment: we are instructed to fulfill all God expects of us in this regard with diligence, faithfulness, and maximum productivity.

Our work must not be done with eye-service or laziness. Diligence and productivity are necessary expressions of our nature in Christ, required to faithfully pursue the assignment given to us to fulfill (Col. 3:22-24; Eph. 6:5-8; Prov. 12:24).

As we draw near the end of our study, we will now examine the second assignment entrusted to us as heirs of God: our spiritual assignment.

Our Assignment as Heirs II



There is such a thing as a spiritual assignment, or inheritance, that God gives to His heirs.

To understand our spiritual assignment, we have to recognise that God's primary goal and desire is to see humanity in His purpose.

This is why He offered His life at origin, and why He accomplished redemption upon sin.

For humanity to be reconciled to Him and restored to His purpose, He assigns a spiritual inheritance to His heirs — for them to reach people across all places, unto their salvation into, establishment in, and fulfilment of His purpose.

This is the context of our spiritual assignment.

Similar to our natural assignment, the language of inheritance is also used to describe the spiritual assignment God has given to us.

For instance, the word *kleros*, which is the primary word in *kleronomos* (heir) and *kleronomia* (inheritance), is used in Acts 1:17 and Acts 1:25 to describe the work of ministry, where it is translated as “part” or “portion”.

Likewise, in 1 Peter 5:3, *kleros* is used to describe the saints under the oversight of church leaders. They are God's heritage, or portion, allotted and entrusted to leaders to oversee.

Yet, as we will see shortly, this idea of ministry as a lot, share, portion, or inheritance is not exclusive to those who are already leaders in church. It extends to every believer in Christ Jesus.

First, every man in Christ has been given the work of ministry, with the message of reconciliation to preach (2 Corinthians 5:17-18).

In fact, it is the work of the leaders of the Church to disciple, train and perfect every saint to do this work of ministry (Ephesians 4:11-12). The earlier verse (Ephesians 4:7) had explained that each of us as saints have a measure of the ministry that Jesus gives, and have been given grace for our measure.

Later, in Ephesians 4:16, Paul again explains that when each member or part of the body of Christ does their measure or share of this ministry, then the body of Christ will grow, increase and be edified.

Remember, you are a significant part of the Body of Christ, as 1 Corinthians 12:27 says, and so you have your individual measure, share, portion and inheritance to fulfill.

How do we then pursue and fulfill our spiritual assignment?

1. The first repeated emphasis about our spiritual assignment is the need for our own discipleship in the local church. It is the perfecting, or discipleship, of the saints that leads to the work of the ministry (Ephesians 4:12).

When it comes to the decision of a local church, the same truth in 1 Corinthians 7:17 applies.

We should commit to be discipled and to serve in the local church that God orchestrates our steps to — either at the instance of salvation, or by further light in His truth, will and purpose for our lives.

This is because we will be judged to the degree of the knowledge of His will that we have and were faithful to (Luke 12:47-48).

2. As we receive discipleship in the church, it will lead to our engagement in the first task of our spiritual assignment: evangelism and soul-winning, where we minister the message to others for their salvation by faith (Mark 16:15-16).
3. Following evangelism, the second task in our spiritual assignment is to disciple the saved. Salvation brings us into God's purpose, but He wants us to fulfill that purpose. Hence, we have the responsibility of helping the saved to grow and become established in the local church.

4. Fourthly, as we faithfully receive the training of the local church and carry out the work of ministry through evangelism and discipleship, we will naturally grow and become qualified for leadership from one level to another in the ministry. 1 Timothy 3:1-13 shows this is a natural expectation and progression when one is growing spiritually and is faithful to their assignment.
5. Finally, we must always be open and receptive to the initiatives and directions of the Spirit relative to our spiritual assignment. The Spirit guides our participation in each phase, and may also lead us into new phases of ministry as we stay faithful.

Every believer has a spiritual assignment, but with divinely elected roles, differing measures and graces.

Our greatest concern should therefore be faithfulness — faithfulness to discipleship in the local church, and faithfulness in carrying out the work of ministry at its most fundamental level.

As we remain faithful, the intended phases and expectations God has for our spiritual assignment will unfold and be fulfilled.

PART THREE



Fulfilling Purpose



*“I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I
have kept the faith.”*

2 TIMOTHY 4:7

Fulfilling God's Purpose

◆

If you have read to this point, you should no longer have any doubts as to why God made you.

It is now clear that God's purpose for your life is Sonship.

He made you to be His child and His heir.

As His child, you are called to:

1. Fellowship with Him;
2. Walk in His nature and character as you grow.

As His heir, you are called to:

1. Civic responsibility, as joint heirs of the world;
2. Your natural assignment; and
3. Your spiritual assignment.

This means we're not trying to invent a purpose for ourselves. Rather, we are part of the long lineage of God's people who discovered and faithfully walked with Him in His purpose — who pursued both their natural and spiritual assignments.

This lineage includes Noah, Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, the prophets and many saints of old. It also includes Paul, Philemon, Onesimus, Priscilla and Aquila, Gaius and many others, who were found walking as children of God, but also serving as heirs of God in both spiritual and natural assignments.

We have no excuse. We must join the number of those who faithfully do all that God has called them to do.

The question now is: what does it take to fulfill God's purpose?

I. Commitment

Upon the knowledge of God's purpose, the first step is to make certain clear decisions and commitments:

1. A commitment to a devotional life of prayer, both for fellowship with God and for growth to walk in our new nature.
2. A commitment and consecration of our natural pursuits to God, recognising them as assignments entrusted to us by Him.
3. A commitment to discipleship in a local church that equips us to carry out our spiritual assignment alongside our natural assignment.

It begins with these three decisions and commitments.

But it is not enough to make decisions.

2. Discipline

For our decisions and commitment to be strong enough to ensure we fulfill God's purpose, they must be backed up with discipline.

Paul explains this in 1 Corinthians 9:24-27, showing that the accomplishment of any pursuit, whether natural or spiritual, requires discipline: "And everyone who competes for the prize is temperate in all things..."

The word translated "temperate" in verse 25 is *egkrateuomai*, which speaks of self-control, restraint and discipline.

Discipline, as explained here, involves three things:

- (a) Clear goals (v. 25);
- (b) Definite plans to achieve those goals (v. 26); and
- (c) A compelling drive to follow through on the plans until the goals are met (v. 27).

As New Creations, discipline is a fruit produced by the Spirit in us. It is the last character listed in Galatians 5:22-23 (*egkrateia*, meaning self-control, temperance or discipline). The nature of God in us produces the fruit of discipline.

This means that God works in us His compelling *drive* to work out the *plans* that fulfill the *goals* of our assignments. The discipline and drive of God is always at work in us.

We have no excuse.

You cannot say you lack discipline. It is already your nature in Christ. Now, you just have to grow and walk in it.

It doesn't matter how low you have fallen, how far behind you feel you are, or how weak and inconsistent you might have been. Right now, you have all it takes to pursue God's will for you.

You have the discipline and drive of the Spirit.

The question now is: how do we grow and walk in discipline to fulfill God's purpose for our lives?

And this brings us to our final point.

3. Faith Stand

We grow and walk in every reality of the divine nature we have in Christ — including discipline — by faith stand.

Faith stand is the persistent affirmation of who we are in Christ that strengthens us and builds us to walk in our nature. It is done in confession or in prayer.

Different words are used to describe this same reality:

- Romans 6:11 — *reckon* yourself dead to sin and alive to God;
- Romans 6:13 — *present* yourself as an instrument of righteousness.

In these two texts, Paul had explained to the saints in Rome that they are dead to sin and alive unto God, but they need to reckon it and present it if they will grow and walk in it.

The word “reckon” means to take into account something that is already the case. The word “present” literally means to stand beside something as what it is.

You already have the nature of discipline. But you have to reckon and present yourself as such to grow and be transformed to walk in it. That is how you renew your mind — when you present yourself to God ([Romans 12:1-2](#)).

You must confess and affirm that you are not ruled by laziness, disorder, procrastination, or weakness. You must affirm that God's Spirit is driving you to be diligent to carry out all He has called you to do.

No matter how weak you are, you can still be in faith. Even if you are too weak and lazy to get off your bed, you can start out in faith right from your bed ([Psalm 4:4](#)).

From there, you start to have a regular devotional life, where you grow even more and more in who you are, and where you are stirred to daily fulfill your assignment.

It is inevitable that if we stand and stay in faith on any matter of our nature in Christ, we will grow stronger and walk in it.

This is how God's purpose is fulfilled: by daily strengthening ourselves to walk in discipline and all the realities of the divine nature; by refusing to just allow the world to overwhelm and conform us to itself.

If you learn to stand by faith daily, you will end up finishing the race God has set before you — that is, His purpose for your life (2 Timothy 4:7).

Take some time right now to strengthen your commitment to God's purpose for your life. You can affirm this in understanding, and pray in the Spirit too:

I am born of God.

I have His nature of discipline.

I am driven every day by God's Spirit to walk in His purpose.

I am driven to pray in fellowship with the Father and for growth.

I am driven to carry out my assignments — natural and spiritual.

I am driven by the Spirit to fulfill God's purpose for my life. Amen.

Continue with Pleros



We are here to help you fulfill God's purpose. That is why we call you to:

1. **Maintain a consistent prayer devotion** by joining the Pleros Prayer Watch on YouTube — youtube.com/@PlerosLive. The sessions hold three times daily — 5:30 am, 12:30 pm and 8:30 pm — for fifteen minutes each.
2. **Commit to daily growth and transformation** by listening to the Pleros Podcast — pleros.org/podcast.
3. **Get answers, training and discipleship** through the resources available on our website — pleros.org.

The most important thing you can do to fulfill God's purpose is to have a disciplined devotional life — one that keeps you in fellowship with the Father, that transforms you to walk in the Spirit (including your civic responsibility), and that stirs you to faithfully pursue and fulfill your natural and spiritual assignments.

We are here to help you maintain that life of devotion, with the Pleros Prayer Watch and the Pleros Podcast.



T H E E N D

Welcome to God's Purpose



Now — fulfill God's purpose!